use of IT and distance education along with reforms in governance in higher education – major ones are as given below:

- 16 central universities were established which include conversion of three state universities to central universities. Seven new Indian Institutes of Management (IIMs), 8 new Indian Institutes of Technology (IITs), 10 new National Institutes of Technology (NITs), 5 Indian Institutes of Science Education & Research (IISERs), and 2 Schools of Planning and Architecture (SPAs) were also established.
- The National Mission on Education through ICT (NMEICT) which ***aims*** at "providing high speed broadband connectivity to universities and colleges and development of e-content in various disciplines" is under implementation. The low cost access-cum-computing device ***Aakash 2*** was launched in *November 2012*.
- A Scheme of *Interest Subsidy on Educational Loans* to economically weaker sections (EWS) students was introduced from 2009-10.
- An Expert Group was set up by the Prime Minister in order to suggest ways of enhancing employment opportunities in Jammu and Kashmir and to formulate job plans *involving the public and private sectors*. Among the key recommendations of the Expert Group, one is offering scholarships over the next five years, to encourage the youth of Jammu and Kashmir to pursue higher studies outside the state – being implemented since 2011-12.
- To address the increasing *skill challenges* of the Indian IT industry, the government has approved setting up of 20 new Indian Institutes of Information Technology (IIITs) on ***PPP basis*** – to be completed in *nine years* from 2011-12 to 2019-20.

HEALTH

With the National Population Policy, 2000 the idea of family welfare and population control have gone for major shift in the approach. Now, the government thinks that once the living conditions and awareness of the masses are improved, the population will be automatically controlled. Due